

## City Council April 6, 2026

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6B-NymYejvs">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6B-NymYejvs</a> |
| Publication Date | 2026-04-07T12:04:46Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | muncie_city                                                                                           |

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## Muncie City Common Council Meeting Report

**Meeting Date:** April 6, 2026

### 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Green called the regular meeting of the Muncie City Common Council to order on April 6, 2026.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Members Present:** Dishman, Selby, Mackintosh, Green, Powell, Garrett, Golean, Bashaum, Mason.
  - **Members Absent:** None.
  - **Presiding Officer:** President Green.

### 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
  - The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Neil Bashaum, followed by a moment of silence.
  - **Citizen Recognition:** Sarah Golean presented a citizen recognition award to the League of Women Voters of Muncie and Delaware County, accepted by

spokesperson and Indiana State League President Linda Hanson. The presentation highlighted voter registration deadlines, vote centers, and the non-partisan organization's history and mission.

- The council also recognized the Muncie Central drum line for placing second (runner-up) in the state competition.
  - **Approval of Minutes:** Motion made and seconded to approve prior meeting minutes. Passed by roll call vote (all members voting "Yes").
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## 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

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- **00:08:31 Ordinance 7-26:** An ordinance of the City of Muncie amending Chapter 93 of the City of Muncie Code of Ordinances.
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced to the council (previously introduced).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Motion made and seconded to adopt. Brief discussion and call for public comments yielded no speakers.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed by roll call vote (9-0; Bashaum, Mackintosh, Selby, Mason, Powell, Dishman, Garrett, Golean, and President Green voting "Yes").
- **Beech Grove Cemetery Board Appointments:**
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Two board positions were originally slated for appointment but were postponed at the request of the board until next month to allow the council more time to identify interested individuals. (The enabling ordinance was passed previously).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Deferred to next month.
- **00:09:40 Ordinance 8-26:** An ordinance prohibiting the use of documents received from public records requests for commercial purposes.
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced for new ordinances; Legal assessment provided by Jagan Arnold.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Legal counsel noted that while the ordinance largely mirrors state statute and administrative code regarding commercial data resale, a 10-year restriction clause at the end of the ordinance was not found in state code and raised potential First Amendment/arbitrary enforcement concerns. Following this assessment, the sponsor withdrew the ordinance.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Withdrawn by the sponsor.
- **00:11:44 Resolution 5-26:** A resolution of the Common Council of the City of Muncie, Indiana updating appointments to the Muncie Human Rights Commission.
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by Gretchen Cheesman (Human Rights Commission member) and Shaquille Webster (new Human Rights Commission Executive Director).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Presenters explained that a review of past council minutes revealed historical misalignments in mayoral and council appointments, leading to

an imbalance in term expirations (four expiring in '26, four in '27, one in '28).

Resolution Exhibit 1 realigns these terms to restore the proper statutory balance (3-year terms: 2 mayoral appointments, 1 council appointment).

- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
  - *Mr. Skeens* raised concerns regarding a potential conflict of interest regarding a city department head (Community Development Director) serving on the Human Rights Commission board, citing executive sessions and internal city complaints.
  - Discussion ensued among council members, Gretchen Cheesman, and city staff regarding recusal protocols and board access to confidential investigation minutes.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed by roll call vote (9-0; Garrett, Nash, Dishman, Powell, Mason, Selvey, McIntosh, Julian, and Green voting "Yes").
- **00:24:27 Resolution 6-26:** A resolution authorizing Mayor Dan Ridenour (noted in transcript as Dan Wirenauer) to apply for Community Development Block Grants (CDBG) and HOME Investment Partnership Program grant funds from HUD.
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by Gretchen Cheesman, Director of Community Development.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Cheesman reported updated federal allocations, requiring an amendment to the resolution:
    - *HOME allocation:* Reduced by roughly 7% (\$36,763.76 reduction) to **\$471,998.35**.
    - *CDBG allocation:* Reduced by approximately 1% (\$12,298 reduction) to **\$1,229,825**.
    - Detailed the proposed budget caps and spending categories (admin caps, public service allocations serving the homeless<U+2014>A Better Way, Muncie Mission, YWCA, Christian Ministries<U+2014>blight clearance, homeowner rehab, and infrastructure).
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
    - *Mr. Ricky Yancey* commented on federal budget impacts on community development and inquired about past housing/homelessness funds designated for the old Harrison school project. Cheesman and staff clarified that the permanent supportive housing project is advancing through a low-income housing tax credit and real estate closing slated for month-end.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
    - Motion to amend budget figures passed by voice vote ("Aye").
    - Motion to adopt Resolution 6-26 as amended passed by roll call vote (9-0; Dishman, Gowan, Saracino, McIntosh, Harris, Selby, Powell, and President Green voting "Yes").
- **Tabled Ordinances:**
  - Ordinance 29-25 remains on the table (not pulled).

- Resolution 4-26 remains tabled with no movement.

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## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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- **00:40:43 Mr. Rick Hanson:** Addressed law enforcement concerns regarding a recent welfare check incident, raised questions regarding county surveillance agreements (Flock cameras/software privacy risks), and urged the city to focus on job creation and tax assessment concerns.
- **00:42:38 Mr. Wayne Scape:** Commented on Resolution 15-25 regarding the community center committee, expressing frustration over historical delays (17 years since the original center was torn down) and questioning whether the mayor possesses unilateral authority to call/cancel committee meetings or remove board members. Council members and legal counsel confirmed the resolution does not grant the mayor unilateral administrative control over the committee.
- **00:49:25 Mr. Christopher Bilberry:** Criticized council responsiveness, specifically alleging that Council Member Bashaum failed to respond to emails regarding withdrawn ordinances. He also raised concerns regarding crisis center oversight.

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## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - Public comment and public hearing regarding the Community Development action plan remain open online through April 20th, with a public hearing scheduled for 10:00 AM on Friday.
- **Adjournment:** Motion to adjourn made and seconded; approved by voice vote. Meeting adjourned.

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